

WOLLIE / COMPETITIVE DEEP DIVE

Wise, Revolut, and Monarch

UX, UI, product logic, strengths, weaknesses, and decisions for Wollie

Wise / Revolut / Monarch
Research current to 1 September 2026

Official product documentation and annual reports are the primary evidence. Public user discussions are labeled as anecdotal signals.

The answer in one page

These products are not three versions of the same app. Wise is an international money account, Revolut is a digital banking super-app, and Monarch is a cross-bank planning layer. Wollie should combine their strongest interaction patterns without combining their complexity.

Recommended position A calm, couples-first money planning layer across joint, separate, or mixed bank accounts. It coordinates the household without pretending a virtual plan moved real money.

WISE

Clarity

Borrow its balance, transaction, status, and fee hierarchy.

REVOLUT

Immediacy

Borrow rule previews, instant feedback, and real joint boundaries.

MONARCH

Planning

Borrow household aggregation, review queues, rules, goals, and reports.

The non-negotiable model

BANK REALITY

Balances, transactions, transfers, pending and cleared states.

Answers: what actually moved?

WOLLIE PLAN

Virtual assignments to spending, tax, pension, savings, and goals.

Answers: what is this month's money meant to do?

A pension target is planned until a matching outgoing contribution is detected or confirmed. It must not appear as everyday spending.

Category map

The correct benchmark depends on the job being evaluated.

PRODUCT	PRIMARY JOB	HOUSEHOLD MODEL	BEST AT	MAIN GAP
Wise	Hold, convert, send, spend	Owner-led shared spending	Clear ledger and international money movement	Not a household planning system
Revolut	Daily digital banking	Two-person joint account plus personal accounts	Actual-money automation and control	Feature and analytics fragmentation
Monarch	Cross-bank planning	Shared household subscription	Review, budgets, goals, reports	Sync trust and no real privacy
Wollie	Couples money coordination	Joint, separate, or mixed banks	Fair contributions plus selective sharing	Must prove data and plan accuracy

What each product optimizes

- Wise optimizes a transfer or balance event. Its success metric is confidence that the money arrived at a fair cost.
- Revolut optimizes action and engagement. Its success metric is how much of a person's financial life happens inside Revolut.
- Monarch optimizes understanding and planning. Its success metric is whether connected data becomes a coherent monthly and long-term picture.
- Wollie should optimize household agreement. Its success metric is whether both partners understand what is available, what is reserved, and what needs attention.

Design consequence Do not benchmark Wollie's Overview against Revolut's entire home screen. Benchmark Accounts against Wise, automation against Revolut, and planning/review against Monarch.

Wise: clarity closest to the ledger

The strongest reference for simple balances, transaction status, and confidence around money movement.

Strategic Report Governance Financial Statements Other Information

Wise Annual Report and Accounts 2025 22

Our Products

Wise Account: faster, cheaper and more global than ever

The Wise Account is our global solution for people with cross-border financial needs, and is increasingly popular with customers who want to send, spend and get paid with more speed, transparency and convenience. The Wise Account now serves 14.9 million active customers across the world. Over half of our customers already use multiple features, and a fast-growing proportion see it as their primary account. Today, the average deposit per customer stands at c.£1,000.

We introduced a range of features over the last year

1. Stronger security and smarter fraud protection

Safety and security is core to our growth, as more and more customers trust us with their money, holding £21.5 billion in their Wise accounts and in Wise Assets. This year, we rolled out Wise Push, an all new secure infrastructure to replace SMS-based two-factor authentication with in-app notifications. We have also introduced smarter scam prevention measures with customers receiving clear, tailored warnings based on their transaction details.

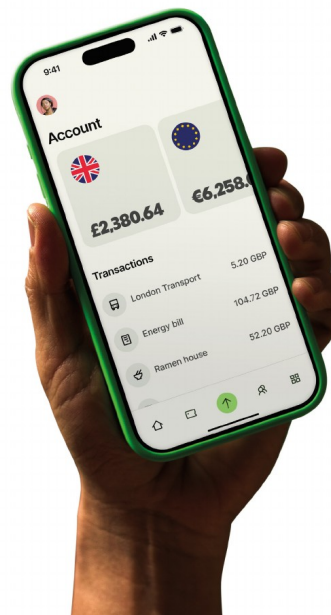
2. Expansion

The Wise Account is now available in the Philippines for personal customers, who can now get paid in over nine currencies, including US dollar, Euro, and British pound and spend it with their Wise Card.

We have also launched Wise Assets in more markets – it is now available in Australia, and throughout most of the EEA, as well as in Singapore and the UK. Customers in those markets can now grow their money with government-guaranteed assets. We have also increased limits in several regions, making larger transfers easier in a number of countries.

3. Convenience: smarter features and better money management

- Spend with others: We have been rolling out this feature to enable customers to pool money with their friends and family, for shared expenses such as holidays or managing bills
- Account summary: We have made it easier for customers to see a snapshot of their holdings, spending and how much they have saved using Wise
- All-new calculator: We have refreshed the transfer calculator, making it faster and easier for customers to set up their transactions
- Money to email: Customers can now send money using just a link – no bank details required
- Digital cards: We have added new designs to help customers differentiate between cards. Use one for spending, one for subscriptions, and another for travel



Wise's FY2025 annual report presents an Account screen built around balances and recent transactions.

How the product thinks

- The home model begins with accounts and currencies, then recent activity and actions.
- Jars separate actual money from the spendable balance.
- Spend with others delegates spending from an owner-controlled pool.
- Public materials emphasize operational money management rather than a household budget.

STRENGTHS

Clear hierarchy
Strong status and fee trust cues
Concrete real-money Jars
Low transaction-list noise

WEAKNESSES

Not a true joint planning model
Owner/member asymmetry
Planning tied to money inside Wise
No full cross-bank household view

Wise: shared money and planning logic



Wise's public Spend with others experience emphasizes a shared spending event, not a household budget.

Spend with others is controlled access

One owner legally owns and controls all money, including member contributions. Members may add money, see transactions, and spend, but cannot send, withdraw, convert, or manage the group. The current EU group limit is two people. This is useful for controlled shared expenses but is not an equal joint account.

Jars are real-money containers

Money in a Jar is separated from the main spendable balance and cannot be used by the debit card or direct debit. This makes the number concrete and prevents accidental spending. It also requires the money to live inside Wise.

Implication for Wollie

Borrow A simple account screen, explicit statuses, and an unmistakable difference between available money and set-aside money.

Avoid Presenting an owner/member permission model as equal household collaboration, or requiring

couples to move shared money into Wollie.

Revolut: immediacy and breadth

The strongest reference for actual-money automation, real joint accounts, and instant financial controls.

Product Development

Retail

Revolut is committed to delivering a complete banking experience globally. Operating as a licensed bank in 30 countries, we continue to expand our local banking services with branch launches and local IBANs in Portugal and Belgium, allowing customers across 13 European markets to directly receive their salary into their Revolut account.

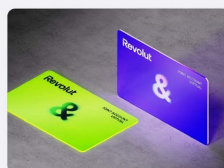
Alongside these expansions, we launched advanced money health features in 2025, including enhanced analytics for spend, income and cashflow overview. A new total wealth view with external account linkages was introduced, allowing users to see all their wealth in one place. We also made account switching in the UK and the Netherlands more accessible than ever for our customers.

To further support everyday banking, we made it easy for customers to access their money with a reimagined digital first ATM experience with 50 ATMs across Spain.

In 2025, Revolut also introduced mortgages in Lithuania, allowing our users to borrow long-term to refinance their mortgage or purchase a new home. Our mortgage facilities provide users with flexibility on repayment terms, remove hidden costs and simplify the refinancing and home purchase journey. Revolut mortgages are fully digital with real-time updates in the app, and local mortgage managers ready to help at every step.

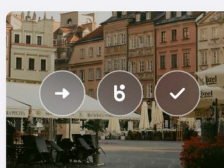
Revolut Trading Ltd. received its investment authorisation in the UK and a licence enhancement in the EEA. We enabled Stocks and Shares ISAs in the UK, in addition to deeper asset coverage with stocks, ETFs and bonds across Europe. Launched in 2025, investment suggestions, smart notifications and our trading money assistant help customers make the most of their investments. As a result of our efforts, average equities balances per customer grew by 24% in 2025. For active investors, we rolled out CFDs, stock order book, more ETFs, enhanced analytics and price charts including a revamped web terminal.

In 2025, we received the MICA licence to continue providing digital asset services in the EEA. We also launched the mobile app of our dedicated crypto exchange, Revolut X, with an App Store rating of 4.9. We continue to enhance our user experience with 1:1 stablecoin conversions with no fees, crypto staking across 15 assets, and approximately 300 assets now available for trading.



Family Banking

Revolut customers can now manage finances together with their family with shared transaction histories, matching cards, joint budgeting tools, joint savings accounts and pockets. We also rolled out Joint and Kids & Teen savings to over 20 countries so users can enjoy a full savings suite for themselves, their partners, and their children. Over 1 million customers created a Revolut Joint Account in 2025.



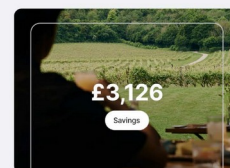
Local Payments

To provide a truly local experience to our customers across the globe we enhanced local payment options in 2025. Customers in Europe can now make payments via Wero and Multibanco in Portugal, Blik P2P in Poland, Pix and Boletão in Brazil and PayID, and BPay and PayTo in Australia.



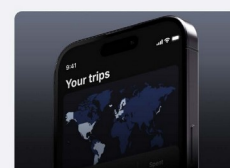
Revolut Suggestions

Allowing our customers to make the most out of their money, Revolut launched investment suggestions and smart notifications in 2025. Users receive expert stock suggestions including detailed return modelling, analyst ratings, technical analysis and sentiment analysis.



Savings Accounts

Our savings and funds products are now available in more than 30 countries globally. To empower our customers to continue growing their wealth, in 2025 we introduced multi-currency savings across Europe. This enables users to earn competitive interest on global currencies in a truly borderless way.



Travel Mode

Making travel more convenient than ever, Revolut also launched Travel Mode and Spend Map in 2025. Customers can now access hyper-localised recommendations including Stays and Experiences, local eSIMs, travel insurance, ATM maps, travel spend controls, airport Lounge access, and localised cash-back offers from their home page when they travel. Users can manage expenses across their travels with the Travel map (spend analytics by country).

Revolut Group Holdings Ltd | Annual Report 2025 | Registered number: 12743269

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Revolut's FY2025 annual report reflects a broad, high-energy super-app rather than a single planning workflow.

How the product thinks

- Personal and joint accounts are separate real ledger containers.
- Income Sorter can distribute actual incoming money to several destinations.
- Pockets, Savings, Investments, cards, and analytics create powerful but distributed states.
- Custom categories and multiple analysis dimensions support exploration.

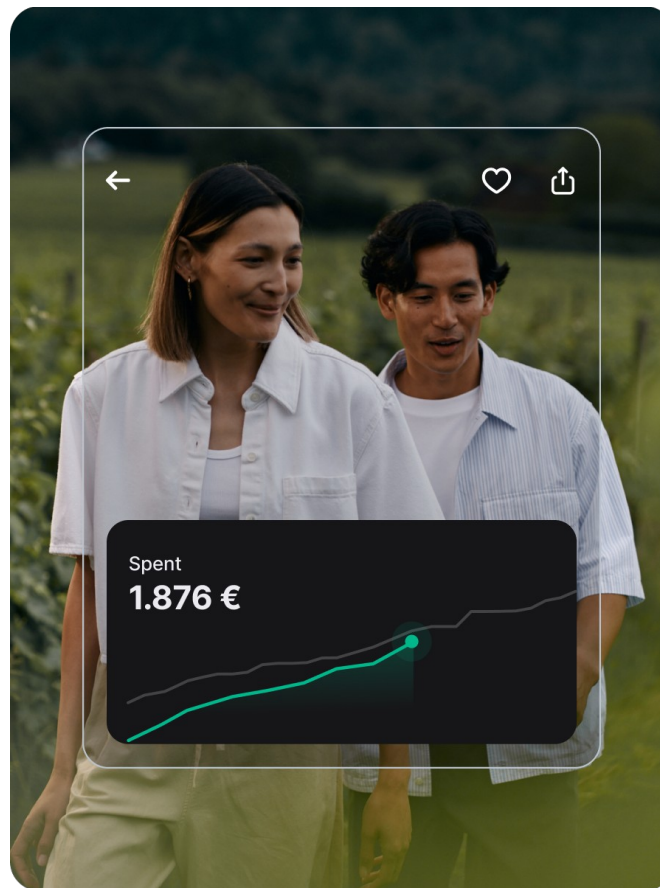
STRENGTHS

True joint account
Fast feedback and control
Useful income automation
Engaging, personalized UI

WEAKNESSES

Feature density
Regional eligibility rules
Joint analytics gaps
Household picture can fragment

Revolut: joint accounts, automation, and analytics



Revolut uses immersive imagery and a high-contrast spending card to make analytics feel immediate and personal.

The joint account is a separate real account

Both holders can add, spend, withdraw, and manage money. Each must already have a verified personal Revolut account, be under the same country/entity, be contacts, and accept the invitation. Joint spending uses cards linked to that account. The clean ledger boundary is useful, but the setup can feel like creating a third account.

Income Sorter moves actual money

When recognized income arrives, users can distribute fixed amounts to destinations such as a joint account, Pockets, Savings, Investments, or another person. This is a strong automation pattern because the trigger, action, and result are visible.

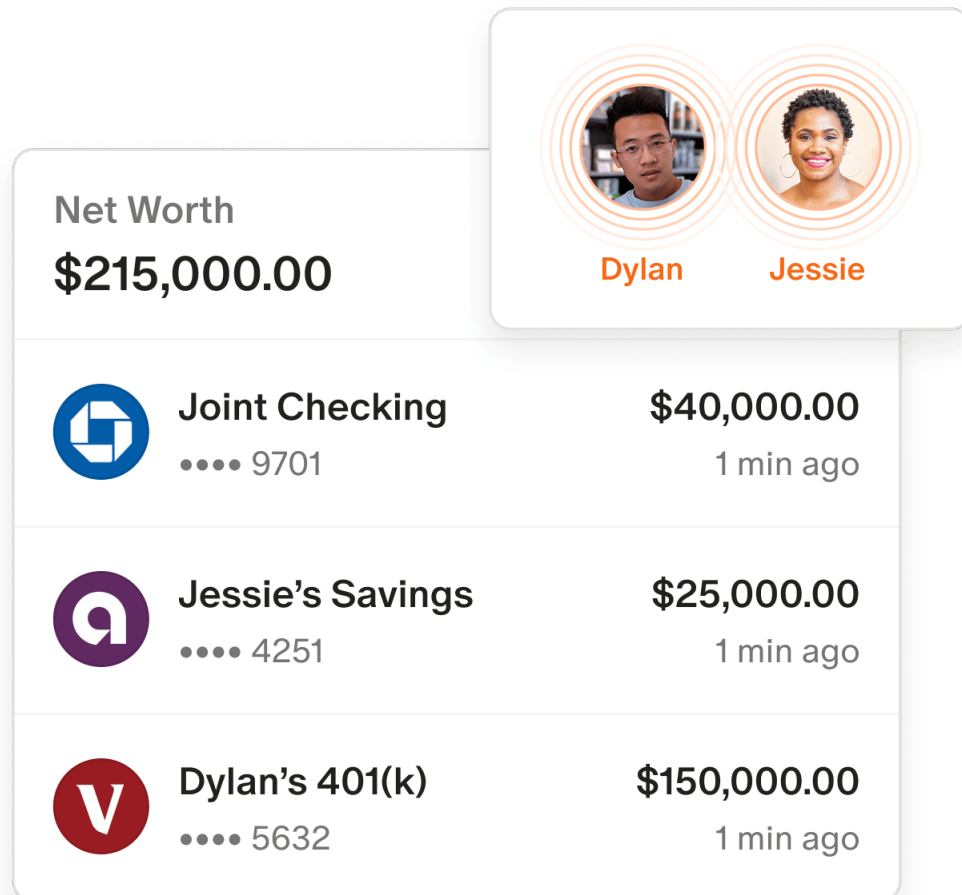
Analytics has a household gap

Revolut supports spending, income, cash flow, total wealth, categories, merchants, countries, currencies, and cards. Current official help material states that joint accounts are excluded from the spending section, so personal analytics does not automatically become one household truth.

Wollie opportunity Use household-wide proportional allocation across multiple incomes. Preview the calculation, then keep virtual assignment separate from any real transfer.

Monarch: the closest planning benchmark

Monarch connects external accounts and turns their data into a household workspace. It is the closest direct reference for Wollie's transactions, plans, goals, recurring expenses, and reports.

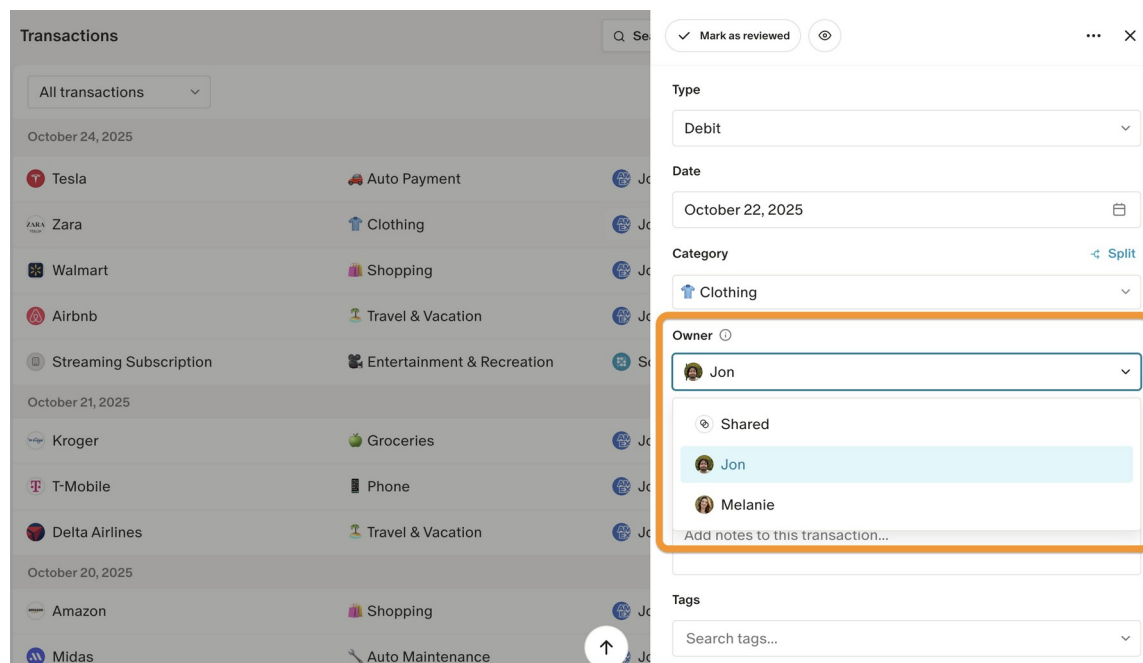


Monarch combines account aggregation, ownership labels, and net worth in one household dashboard.

Why it matters

- Separate logins and one subscription support a real household workflow.
- Connected data is transformed through categories, tags, rules, review assignments, budgets, goals, and reports.
- The product gives value before a budget is complete: cash flow and categorized spending still work.
- Its weaknesses expose the hardest parts of Wollie's problem: sync trust, privacy, and explainable plan maths.

Monarch: collaboration without privacy



Shared Views assigns an owner to a transaction. Ownership changes filtering and attribution, not access permission.

Shared Views

Accounts and transactions can be Shared or Individual and filtered by owner across Accounts, Transactions, Reports, and Cash Flow. Ownership is inherited from an account and may be changed with rules.

Critical limitation Monarch's help centre says all household members still have full visibility. Shared and Individual are labels and filters, not privacy controls. The household also has one shared budget.

Lifecycle friction

A person with an existing Monarch account cannot simply join another household with that account. Official guidance points to using another email/new account or deleting the old account. Removing a member can also remove accounts they added.

Wollie model

Keep legal account ownership, transaction attribution, and visibility as separate fields. Visibility must be enforceable: Private, Shared details, or Household total only.

Monarch: review, rules, and recurring

Transactions
5 need review

Jessie

Anyone

Jessie ✓

Dylan

✓		Starbucks		Coffee	
✓		Apple		Entertainment	
✓		Urban Stems		Gifts	\$85.13
✓		Whole Foods		Groceries	\$21.30
✓		Notion		Software	\$5.00

A household member can own the review task for uncertain transactions. This creates a practical collaboration loop.

Transactions and rules

Each transaction has one category and may have multiple tags. Rules can match merchant, amount, category, or account, then rename, categorize, tag, hide, mark for review, or link to a goal. Rule order matters.

Needs Review

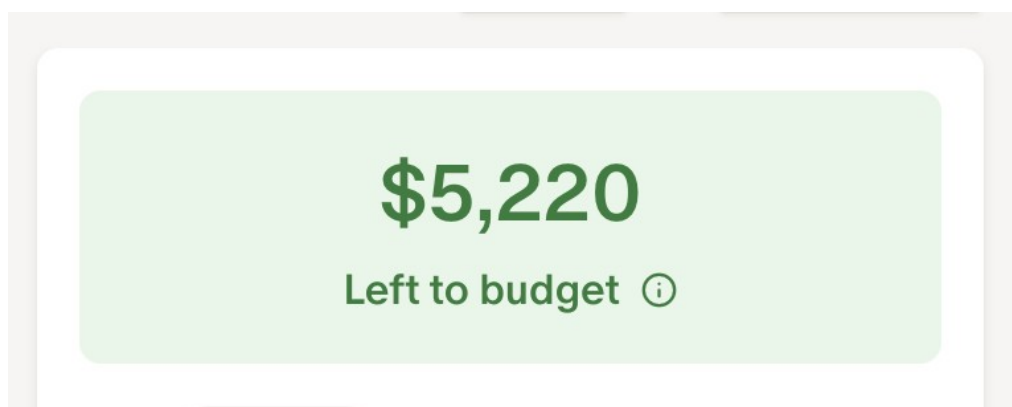
Transactions can be assigned to self, partner, or another household member. This is one of Monarch's best patterns because it makes imperfect automation collaborative instead of invisible.

Recurring detection

Monarch detects recurring merchants, transfers, and paychecks and shows expected dates and status. The model is valuable for forecasting but probabilistic. Wollie should expose confidence, correction, and a link back to supporting transactions.

Simplify for Wollie Ask one review question at a time. Offer Apply once or Create rule. Always provide undo and Why did Wollie do this?

Monarch: budget and goals logic



Monarch's budget summary leads with Left to budget, a useful but calculation-heavy concept.

Category and Flex budgets

The budget is monthly cash-flow based rather than a mirror of account balances. Expected income, planned expenses, and savings determine the monthly picture. Flex budgeting groups fixed, non-monthly, and flexible spending. A category can also have no target and still track spending, which is useful for unpredictable Health expenses.

Rollover

Rollover carries the previous remaining amount into the new month. This is powerful for irregular expenses, but it adds another state users must reconcile with the bank balance.

Goals

Goals can link planned contributions and account balances. Public product changes through 2026 show how difficult the model is to get right. The main risk is blending a planned contribution, an actual transfer, and a changing asset balance.

Wollie rule Every reserve or goal shows Planned this month, Actually contributed, and Current connected balance as separate facts.

Five journeys Wollie must make clearer

JOURNEY	IDEAL WOLLIE BEHAVIOUR
1. Salary arrives	Show recognized income, proportional allocation preview, and new plan amounts. Do not imply money moved.
2. Grocery appears	Categorize to Groceries, map to Food, and reduce the amount left. Keep the transaction row compact.
3. Pension transfer	Count as an actual contribution, not everyday spending. Preserve the original bank transaction.
4. Partner joins	Explain sign in or create account, permissions, visibility, and existing-account rules before connection.
5. Data is uncertain	Send only the uncertain field to Needs review, with a rule preview and undo.

Default income allocation

Allocation to item = received income × item remaining gap ÷ total remaining gaps

Example: if €10,000 arrives against €17,000 of remaining targets, each target receives 58.8% of its remaining gap. Later income continues filling the gaps. No hidden priority order is created.

Transfer and card-payment rule

Card purchases count as spending. Paying the card bill does not count again. Transfers to pension, savings, or investments count as contributions when matched, not as everyday spending.

Traceability Every summary amount must open to the transactions or calculations that compose it. Trust is a product feature.

Recommended Wollie information architecture

Keep five primary destinations. Put household, pricing, and settings in secondary navigation.

DESTINATION	PRIMARY QUESTION	CORE CONTENT
Overview	Where do we stand?	Income received, everyday spending left, saved/invested, needs review, upcoming exceptions
Transactions	What happened?	Merchant, amount, category, account, status, attribution, category totals
Money plan	What should this month's money do?	Tabs: Spending this month; Savings & reserves
Recurring	What is expected next?	Expected date/amount, status, confidence, supporting transactions
Accounts	Where does the money live?	Institution, owner, visibility, balance, sync time, connection health

Overview limit

Use no more than four top-level facts. Suggested default: Income received, Everyday spending left, Saved or invested, and Needs review. Assigned or set aside totals belong inside Money plan unless they answer an immediate decision.

Transaction list rule

Do not repeat a full envelope sentence under every transaction. Show a category chip in the list. Put the detailed plan effect in transaction detail.

Bills versus Money plan

Recurring is a forecast of expected transactions. Money plan is the allowance or reserve. Rent may exist in both without duplication because one answers when payment is expected and the other answers how much is available.

Visual and interaction principles

One colour, one meaning

COLOUR	MEANING	USE
Navy	Stable information	Navigation, major totals, identity
Green	Healthy actual progress	Confirmed contribution or completed target
Amber	Attention soon	Near spending limit, due item, review warning
Red	Real problem	Overspending, failed sync/payment, overdue required reserve
Grey	Neutral progress	Target still filling, inactive, informational

Progressive disclosure

- List view answers what happened.
- Detail view answers why, who, and how it affected the plan.
- Settings answer what should happen next time.
- Do not place all three layers in one row or card.

Design synthesis

Use Wise's calm hierarchy as the baseline. Add Revolut's immediacy only at moments of action. Add Monarch's density only after the user asks for analysis. Keep Wollie's warm illustration and couples identity outside high-stakes numeric surfaces.

The test A user should be able to explain any number in one sentence, then open it and see the exact inputs.

Recommended product decisions

Build now

1. Household Overview with traceable totals.
2. Transactions with totals, categories, Needs review, and simple rules.
3. Money plan tabs for Spending this month and Savings & reserves.
4. Proportional income allocation with a calculation preview.
5. Enforced visibility: Private, Shared details, Household total only.

Build next

6. Recurring detection with confidence and correction.
7. Partner Light for a less hands-on partner.
8. Contribution views for fixed, equal, and proportional sharing.
9. Goal destination matching and actual contribution detection.
10. Audit trail and undo for automatic rules.

Avoid until the core is trusted

- Moving money or executing transfers.
- Cards, investments, or a broad marketplace.
- A dashboard made of many configurable widgets.
- Forecasts that cannot be reconciled to source transactions.
- Gamification that treats overspending as shame.

North star Both partners can answer: What can we spend? What did we save? What still needs attention?

Sources and evidence notes

Official sources were accessed on 1 September 2026. Product availability, pricing, and regional rules may change. Annual-report screenshots are included as public product evidence. Reddit links are qualitative anecdotes, not prevalence estimates.

Wise official

- [Spend with others help](#)
- [Spend with others](#)
- [Jars](#)
- [Scheduled transfers](#)
- [Pricing](#)

Revolut official

- [Joint account setup](#)
- [Income Sorter](#)
- [Spending and income analytics](#)
- [Custom categories](#)
- [Belgian pricing](#)
- [FY2025 annual report](#)

Monarch official

- [For couples](#)
- [Shared Views](#)
- [Monarch for Couples](#)
- [Understanding your budget](#)
- [Transaction rules](#)
- [Reviewing transactions](#)
- [Recurring expenses](#)
- [Reports](#)
- [Product updates](#)

Anecdotal user-discussion index

- [Wise and Revolut comparison](#)
- [Revolut joint-account setup confusion](#)
- [Revolut joint-account creation errors](#)
- [Revolut analytics history complaint](#)
- [Revolut Pockets analytics complaint](#)
- [Monarch account-sync complaint](#)
- [Monarch duplicate transactions and trust](#)
- [Monarch private budgets and transactions request](#)
- [Monarch goals criticism](#)
- [Monarch budget criticism](#)

Research limits

This is desk research, not a regulated account-opening or long-term sync test. Public screenshots may depict selected marketing states. Public discussions may be incomplete or unrepresentative. Validate the final Wollie flows with real couples using joint, separate, and mixed accounts.